



Fix your Wi-Fi first

Cover every corner, so your automations don't fail

If home automation is the show, Wi-Fi is the stage. Most “device offline” alerts, routines that trigger late, and voice assistants that stall come down to three Cs: coverage, congestion, and consistency.

On top of all that, Indian homes add their own constraints – reinforced concrete, long corridors, and power cuts that reboot your router at the worst moment. So before you expand your smart kit, fix the invisible hub – your wireless network.

1) Know your Wi-Fi bands

Faster Wi-Fi is not always better Wi-Fi.

- 2.4 GHz travels farther and penetrates walls better, but it's slower and more crowded.
- 5 GHz (and 6 GHz, if you have Wi-Fi 6E/7) is faster and cleaner, but range drops faster through walls.

Remember this, even if you don't understand every little technical detail: 2.4 GHz offers longer range at lower data rates; 5/6 GHz offer higher speeds with shorter range. Meraki's channel-planning notes echo the same physical reality: 2.4 GHz generally travels further and penetrates better than 5 GHz.

The smart-home twist: many IoT devices still prefer – or only support – 2.4 GHz. A common setup failure? Your phone sits on 5 GHz while the smart device only supports 2.4 GHz.

Step-by-step: do the “band reality” check (5 min)

1. In your router/app, see whether 2.4 and 5 GHz share one Wi-Fi name (SSID) or are split.
2. Check a few smart-device boxes/manuals and note which are 2.4-only.